

A MIRROR. A METHOD. THE PART OF YOU YOU STOPPED LOOKING AT.

SHADOW WORK

◇ PROTOCOL · CONFRONTATION, GROUNDING, INTEGRATION

Every person carries a private register of traits they were taught to disown -- the anger, the need, the ambition, the appetite. Denied a home in daylight, they don't disappear. They run the show from the dark, disguised as other people's flaws.

This protocol doesn't ask you to fix yourself. It asks you to stop lying about what's already there.

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- EVIDENCE VS. STORY
 - BODY SCAN
 - MIRROR CHECK + FUTURE ECHO
 - COST LEDGER
 - LIE DETECTOR
 - GROUNDING PRACTICE

This work can surface old material. Go at the pace your nervous system can hold. If something won't settle with grounding, that's a signal for a therapist, not a reason to stop.

THE REASON BEHIND THIS PROTOCOL

WHAT YOU REJECT DOES NOT LEAVE. IT HIDES AND WAITS.

Carl Jung named it the shadow -- the parts of the self that consciousness refuses to claim. Not because they are evil. Because somewhere young, someone decided they were unacceptable, and the child adapted by hiding them.

What gets hidden does not vanish. It gets outsourced. You see it first in other people -- the trait that provokes you out of proportion, the person who repels you for reasons you can't quite name. Psychologists call this projection: attributing to someone else what you can't yet admit is yours.

Confrontation is not punishment. It is recovery. Every disowned trait carries a distorted gift beside the shame -- the aggression that felt dangerous at seven might be the boundary you need at thirty-five. Integration means taking the trait out of the dark and giving it a supervised job in your actual life.

This is not comfortable work. Go at the pace your nervous system can hold. If old material surfaces and will not settle with grounding, that is a signal to bring in a licensed therapist -- not a reason to stop the work entirely.

01

EVIDENCE VS. STORY · PROJECTION AS EVIDENCE

WHO IRRITATES YOU, AND WHY?

The people who trigger you disproportionately are carrying your disowned traits. Start with them.

Name someone whose behavior provokes a reaction stronger than the situation calls for. What exactly do they do?

The behavior that gets to me is...

If this trait belonged to you instead of them, what would that mean about you?

If this were mine, it would mean...

02

BODY SCAN · THE SOMATIC SIGNAL

WHERE DOES THE REACTION LIVE?

Before the mind catches up, the body already knows. Track the physical evidence.

Where do you feel it in your body when this trait shows up in someone else?

It hits me in my...

What does your body want to do in that moment -- clench, flee, attack, disappear?

My body wants to...

03

MIRROR CHECK + FUTURE ECHO · ORIGIN AND OWNERSHIP

**WHO TAUGHT YOU THIS WAS
UNACCEPTABLE?**

Every disowned trait has an install date. Find it, then decide who runs the update now.

When you were young, who made this trait unsafe to show, and how did they make that clear?

I learned this was unacceptable when...

If you let yourself hold this trait without apology, what would change about how you move through a room?

If I owned this, I would...

04

COST LEDGER · THE PRICE OF HIDING

WHAT HAS DENIAL COST YOU?

Every rejected part still gets paid for. Take the full account.

What has hiding this trait cost you -- energy, relationships, opportunities?

Hiding this has cost me...

What might this same trait give you if it were integrated instead of exiled?

If I integrated this, it could give me...

05

LIE DETECTOR · THE SUBSTITUTE MASK

WHAT ARE YOU WEARING INSTEAD?

Every hidden trait gets replaced with a performance. Name the performance.

What persona do you perform to keep this trait hidden from others -- and from yourself?

The mask I wear instead is...

What would it cost you to drop the mask in one specific, low-stakes moment this week?

One place I could drop it is...

BEFORE YOU GO DOWN. AFTER YOU SURFACE.

GROUND YOURSELF ON THE WAY IN AND ON THE WAY OUT.

BEFORE YOU GO DOWN

ARRIVE IN THE ROOM

Do this before starting any step above. Thirty to sixty seconds is enough.

- 01 Feel the actual weight of your body against the chair or floor. Name the contact points.
- 02 Notice 5 things you can see, 4 you can hear, 3 you can touch, 2 you can smell, 1 you can name about your breath.
- 03 Breathe in for a count of 4, out for a count of 6. Five rounds, exhale longer than inhale.

AFTER YOU SURFACE

CLOSE THE FILE

Do this after any step that stirred something. Don't skip it because you feel fine.

- 01 Say out loud or write: "This is old information. I am not in that moment now."
- 02 Name one true, current fact about where you are: the date, the room, a sound nearby.
- 03 Do one physical action that signals completion -- stand, stretch, drink water, open a window.

THE WORK ISN'T DONE UNTIL IT LIVES IN YOUR ACTUAL LIFE.

06

INTEGRATION · CARRY IT FORWARD

WHAT DOES THIS TRAIT BECOME NOW?

Integration is not a feeling. It's a behavior, repeated on purpose, in daylight.

Pick one small, real, low-stakes way this trait could show up on purpose this week.

This week, I will let this trait show up by...

What will you say to yourself the first time it goes well?

When it goes well, I will tell myself...